

Executive Summary: How to Start the Google AI Agent Challenge

Overview

The Google for Startups **AI Agent Challenge** helps founders move from prototype to production using Gemini, the Agent Development Kit (ADK), and the Model Context Protocol (MCP). This summary provides a clear, actionable starting plan tailored for startups building or optimizing autonomous agents.

1. Choose Your Track

Select the track that matches the maturity of your agent:

- **Track 1 — Build (Net-New Agents)** Create a new autonomous agent using ADK, LangChain, CrewAI, or your own framework.
- **Track 2 — Optimize (Existing Agents)** Improve reliability, reasoning, and production behavior of an existing agent.
- **Track 3 — Refactor for Google Cloud Marketplace** Transform a working agent into a scalable, monetizable product ready for enterprise distribution.

Recommended for you: Track 2 or Track 3, based on your architecture and GenAI background.

2. Register / Sign Up

To participate, ensure you have:

- A **Google for Startups** account
- A **Google Cloud project**
- Agreement to challenge terms
- Your startup details linked

If the page shows **Sign Up / Apply / Join the Challenge**, click it. If not, scroll — it is typically mid-page or at the bottom.

3. Set Up Your Environment

Google expects participants to use:

- **Gemini models**
- **Agent Development Kit (ADK)**
- **Model Context Protocol (MCP)**
- **Google Cloud toolchain** (Vertex AI, Cloud Run, Cloud Functions, Pub/Sub)

Minimum setup steps:

1. Create a Google Cloud project
2. Enable Vertex AI
3. Install ADK locally
4. Configure MCP tool connections
5. Claim your \$500 startup credits (after acceptance)

4. Define Your Agent Use Case

Your submission must demonstrate:

- A real business problem
- A multi-step autonomous workflow
- MCP-based tool usage
- Production-grade reliability

Ideal candidates for you:

- **TaskPilot.AI** — Autonomous planner + focus coach + meeting summarizer
- **Book2Notes** — Autonomous reading → notes → insights pipeline

5. Build or Optimize Your Agent

Track 1: Build

- Define agent intent using ADK

- Connect tools via MCP
- Implement autonomous loops
- Deploy a working prototype

Track 2: Optimize

- Stress-test reasoning
- Add guardrails
- Improve reliability
- Add evaluation harnesses
- Fix edge-case failures

Track 3: Refactor

- Containerize the agent
- Add Marketplace metadata
- Implement billing + usage tracking
- Ensure enterprise-grade security

6. Prepare Your Submission

Your final submission must include:

- A working agent
- A demo video
- A GitHub repository
- A technical write-up
- A business impact explanation

Deadline: June 5, 2026 at 5 PM PT

7. Submit & Compete

Prizes include:

- Cash awards
- Google Cloud credits
- Expert mentorship
- VIP event access
- Social media promotion

Optional: Full Challenge Plan

If needed, you can request:

- Track selection guidance
- Agent architecture design
- MCP tool integration plan
- Gemini + ADK workflow design
- Submission outline
- Demo script
- GitHub structure